

THE HELMSMAN



A COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE FOR FUTURE RECRUITS

SR _____

COMPANY _____



UNITED STATES
COAST GUARD
PROTECT / DEFEND / SAVE





THE U.S. COAST GUARD ETHOS

IN SERVICE TO OUR NATION

WITH HONOR, RESPECT, AND DEVOTION TO DUTY

WE PROTECT

WE DEFEND

WE SAVE

WE ARE SEMPER PARATUS

WE ARE THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD

CONGRATULATIONS on your decision to join the United States Coast Guard.

We welcome you and your family into our family. We're excited to see what you'll become in our organization. Whether you're joining right out of high school, after earning a college degree, leaving a civilian job, or transferring from another service, you'll have the opportunity to advance yourself as you leverage the endless possibilities a career in the Coast Guard has to offer.



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WELCOME ABOARD!

WELCOME ABOARD



WELCOME ABOARD

As a member of our organization, your first order is to read, understand, and acknowledge the information provided here in ***The Helmsman***. There are many new experiences and opportunities ahead for future recruits and we want you to understand all the requirements and responsibilities that are expected of you as you prepare for **Recruit Basic Training at Training Center Cape May, New Jersey**. Ask your recruiter about information that is unclear.



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Warning Order

The information you provided for enlistment is considered a statement of fact to the best of your knowledge. If you provided information that is knowingly false, you may be prosecuted in accordance with the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ) or administratively separated. This violation may be punishable by fines, imprisonment, or both. Providing a false statement or acknowledgement of fact includes, but is not limited to, the following information:

- Police/civil involvement
- Drug use
- Prior military service
- Medical history
- Education
- Age
- Dependents

UCMJ ARTICLE 104a (10 USC 904a) FRAUDULENT ENLISTMENT, APPOINTMENT, OR SEPARATION.

Any person who: (1) Procures his/her own enlistment or appointment in the armed forces by knowingly false representation or deliberate concealment as to their qualifications for the enlistment or appointment and receives pay or allowances thereunder; or (2) Procures his/her own separation from the armed forces by knowingly false representation or deliberate concealment as to their eligibility for that separation, shall be punished as a court-martial may direct.



The U.S. Coast Guard, one of the country's five armed services, is a unique agency of the federal government. We trace our history to 4 August 1790, when the first Congress authorized the construction of 10 vessels to enforce tariff and trade laws and to prevent smuggling. Known through the 19th and early 20th centuries as the Revenue Cutter Service, we expanded in size and responsibilities as the nation grew.

The service received its present name in 1915 under an act of Congress when the Revenue Cutter Service merged with the Life-Saving Service. The nation then had a single maritime service dedicated to saving life at sea and enforcing the nation's maritime laws. The Coast Guard began to maintain the country's aids to maritime navigation, including operating the nation's lighthouses, when President Franklin Roosevelt ordered the transfer of the Lighthouse Service to the Coast Guard in 1939. In 1946, Congress permanently transferred the Bureau of Marine Inspection and Navigation to the Coast Guard, thereby placing merchant marine licensing and merchant vessel safety under our purview. The Coast Guard took over the administration of bridges over navigable waterways in 1967.

We've continued to protect the nation throughout our long history and have served proudly in our nation's conflicts. Our national defense responsibilities remain one of our most important functions, even today. In times of peace, we operate as part of the U.S. Department of Homeland Security, serving as the nation's front-line agency for enforcing our laws at sea, protecting the marine environment and our vast coastline and ports, and conducting search and rescue operations. In times of war, or at the direction of the President, we serve under the U.S. Department of the Navy. The Coast Guard is simultaneously and at all times a military force and federal law enforcement agency dedicated to maritime safety, security, and stewardship missions.

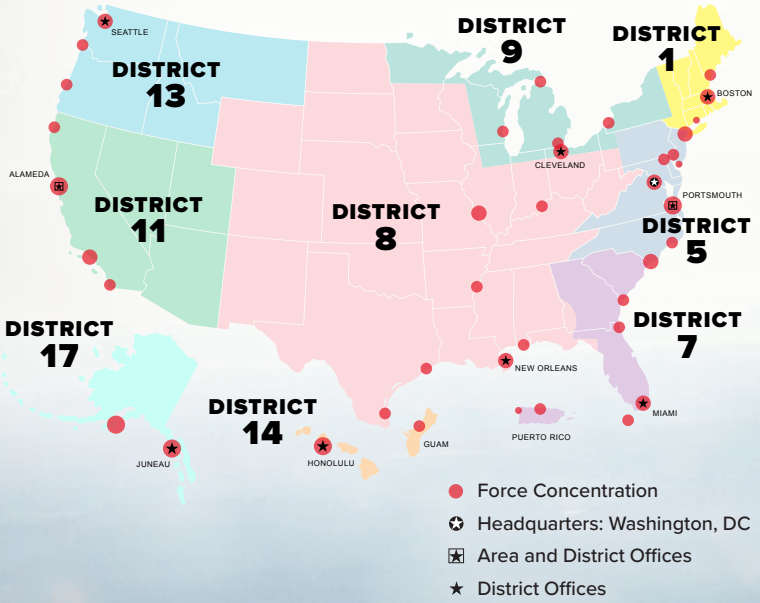
We save lives. We protect the environment. We defend the homeland. We enforce federal laws on the high seas, the nation's coastal waters, and its inland waterways through our **11 missions**:

- **Port, Waterways & Coastal Security**
- **Drug Interdiction**
- **Aids to Navigation**
- **Search & Rescue**
- **Living Marine Resources**
- **Marine Safety**
- **Defense Readiness**
- **Migrant Interdiction**
- **Maritime Environmental Protection**
- **Polar, Ice & Alaska Operations**
- **Law Enforcement**

The Coast Guard's units, vessels, and aircraft are permanently deployed in the communities we serve. Our unique role as the only armed service in the Department of Homeland Security gives us both civilian and military responsibilities. We protect America's economic prosperity, national security, and border—from the heartland to cyberspace.

The Coast Guard is divided into **two geographic commands**: the Atlantic Area and Pacific Area. The Areas are further divided into **nine district commands**. The Atlantic Area includes **five district commands** covering the Eastern United States, the Atlantic Ocean, the Great Lakes, and the Gulf of Mexico. The Pacific Area includes **four district commands** covering the Western United States and the Pacific Ocean. The Coast Guard also has personnel assigned to eight Department of Defense Combatant Commands and often has a presence on all seven continents and the world's oceans, protecting national sovereignty with our icebreakers, cutters, aviation assets, and deployable specialized forces.







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PREPARATION



PREPARATION

Recruit basic training is rigorous and demanding. To succeed, you must commit to preparing yourself now. Prior to your arrival for recruit basic training, you need to prepare yourself physically, mentally, financially, and bring the permitted personal items listed in this section of *The Helmsman*.

PHYSICAL FITNESS

You **MUST** arrive physically fit and ready to comfortably **EXCEED** the minimum standards listed on [page 16](#). If you're taking the first steps toward fitness, ensure that you consult with your doctor before starting any fitness training program.

The Four Elements of Fitness

Fitness training balances four elements of good health. Make sure your routine includes **aerobic fitness, strength training, core exercises, and flexibility and stretching**.

Aerobic Fitness

Aerobic activity, also known as cardio or endurance activity, is the cornerstone of most fitness training programs. Aerobic activity or exercise causes you to breathe faster and more deeply, which maximizes the amount of oxygen in your blood. Your heart will beat faster, increasing blood flow to your muscles and back to your lungs.

The better your aerobic fitness, the more efficiently your heart, lungs, and blood vessels transport oxygen throughout your body, and the easier it is to complete routine physical tasks and rise to unexpected challenges.

Aerobic activity includes any physical activity that uses large muscle groups and increases your heart rate. Try walking, jogging, biking, swimming, and water aerobics.

The U.S. Department of Health and Human Services recommends that you get at least 150 minutes of moderate aerobic activity or 75 minutes of vigorous aerobic activity a week, or a combination of moderate and vigorous

activity. The guidelines suggest that you spread out this exercise during the course of a week. You can also try high-intensity interval training, which involves alternating short bursts of intense activity (around 30 seconds) with subsequent recovery periods (around three to four minutes) of lighter activity. For example, you could include bursts of running in your brisk jogs.

Strength Training

Muscular fitness is another key component of a fitness training program. Strength training can help you increase bone strength and muscular fitness, and it can help you manage or lose weight. It can also improve your ability to do everyday activities. Aim to include strength training of all the major muscle groups into your fitness routine at least twice a week.

Most fitness centers offer various resistance machines, free weights, and other tools for strength training. Resistance bands are an inexpensive option. Your own body weight counts, too. Try push-ups, pull-ups, bent-knee sit-ups and leg squats.

Core Exercises

The muscles in your abdomen, lower back, and pelvis (known as your core muscles) help protect your back and connect upper and lower body movements. Core strength is a key element of a well-rounded fitness training program.

Core exercises help train your muscles to brace the spine and enable you to use your upper and lower body muscles more effectively. A core exercise is any exercise that uses the trunk of your body without support, such as bridges, planks, bent-knee sit-ups, and fitness ball exercises.

Flexibility/Stretching

Flexibility is an important aspect of physical fitness and it's a good idea to include stretching and flexibility activities in a fitness program. Stretching exercises can help increase flexibility, which can make it easier for you to do many everyday activities.

Stretching can improve the range of motion of your joints and may promote better posture. Regular stretching can even help relieve stress and tension.

Consider stretching after you exercise—when your muscles are warm and receptive to stretching. If you want to stretch before a workout, warm up first by walking or exercising for 5–10 minutes before stretching.

Ideally, you'll stretch whenever you exercise. If you don't exercise regularly, you might want to stretch at least two to three times a week after warming up to maintain flexibility. Activities such as yoga promote flexibility, too.

Cover All the Bases

Aim to incorporate aerobic fitness, strength training, core exercises, and flexibility/stretching into your exercise plan. It isn't necessary to fit each of these elements into every fitness session, but factoring them into your regular routine can help you promote fitness for life and help prepare you for basic training.

Special Note

- To maintain weight and health, do 150 minutes of moderate-intensity physical activity per week.
- To lose weight, do 300 minutes of moderate-intensity physical activity per week.
- Stop using any tobacco or e-cigarette products immediately.
- If 21 or older, moderate your alcohol use and/or stop consumption of alcohol.
- Follow a low-fat nutrition plan.
- Dress accordingly for the elements.
- Invest in footwear that aligns with your fitness training program to reduce the chance of injury.
- Make sure you stay hydrated.

*Train now.
Come ready!*



MINIMUM PHYSICAL FITNESS STANDARDS

Bent-knee Sit-ups

Minimum Qualification for Graduation

- *Male: 38 in one minute*
- *Female: 32 in one minute*

This exercise measures abdominal muscular endurance.

Lie on your back, knees bent, feet flat on the deck, hands cupped behind your ears, and if necessary, have someone hold your feet for stability. Keep your lower back on the deck and raise your upper body approximately 90 degrees, touching your elbows to your knees before beginning a controlled descent back to the deck. Once your lower back touches the deck, you can raise your upper body again. Do not tuck your chin into your chest as this causes strain on your neck.

Push-ups

Minimum Qualification for Graduation

- *Male: 29 in one minute*
- *Female: 15 in one minute*

This exercise measures the muscular endurance of the upper body.

Place your hands shoulder width apart, your feet together, and your body forming a straight line from the shoulders to the ankles. Keep your body straight throughout the exercise. Lower your body until your chest touches the pad, then push up to the initial position by completely straightening the arms. Your goal is to exceed the physical fitness qualifications for graduation.

*Practice now.
Come ready!*

1.5 Mile Run

Minimum Qualification for Graduation

- *Male: 12:51*
- *Female: 15:26*

This exercise measures your full body endurance.

Stretch thoroughly before you begin running. Wear running shoes that fit properly. Pick a good running surface. If a track is not available, choose a level street to run on. Relax and breathe properly. Keep your elbows close to your sides to conserve energy. Practice lengthening your stride to reduce stress on your joints. When you get tired, slow to a brisk walk and continue pumping your arms to maintain aerobic heart rate. If you haven't run for a long time, or have never run, you should start out with a walk/run program.

Swimming

Minimum Qualification for Graduation

- *Jump off a six-foot platform into the pool, swim 100 meters, and tread water for five minutes. Swimming on your back is not permitted.*

This exercise measures your ability to swim.

It is strongly recommended that you show up already knowing the basics of how to swim and be comfortable in the water. There are seven essential components to a good swimming training program: stretching, warm-up, kick pull or drill sets, major set, timed swim, sprints, and cool-down.

**Failure to meet the physical fitness standards of the bent-knee sit-ups, push ups, and the 1.5 mile run may result in being held in Week 1 until successful completion of the assessment, being placed in physical fitness remedial training, or being discharged from the Coast Guard. Failure to meet the swimming standards will result in being placed in remedial swim until successful completion of the swimming standards.*

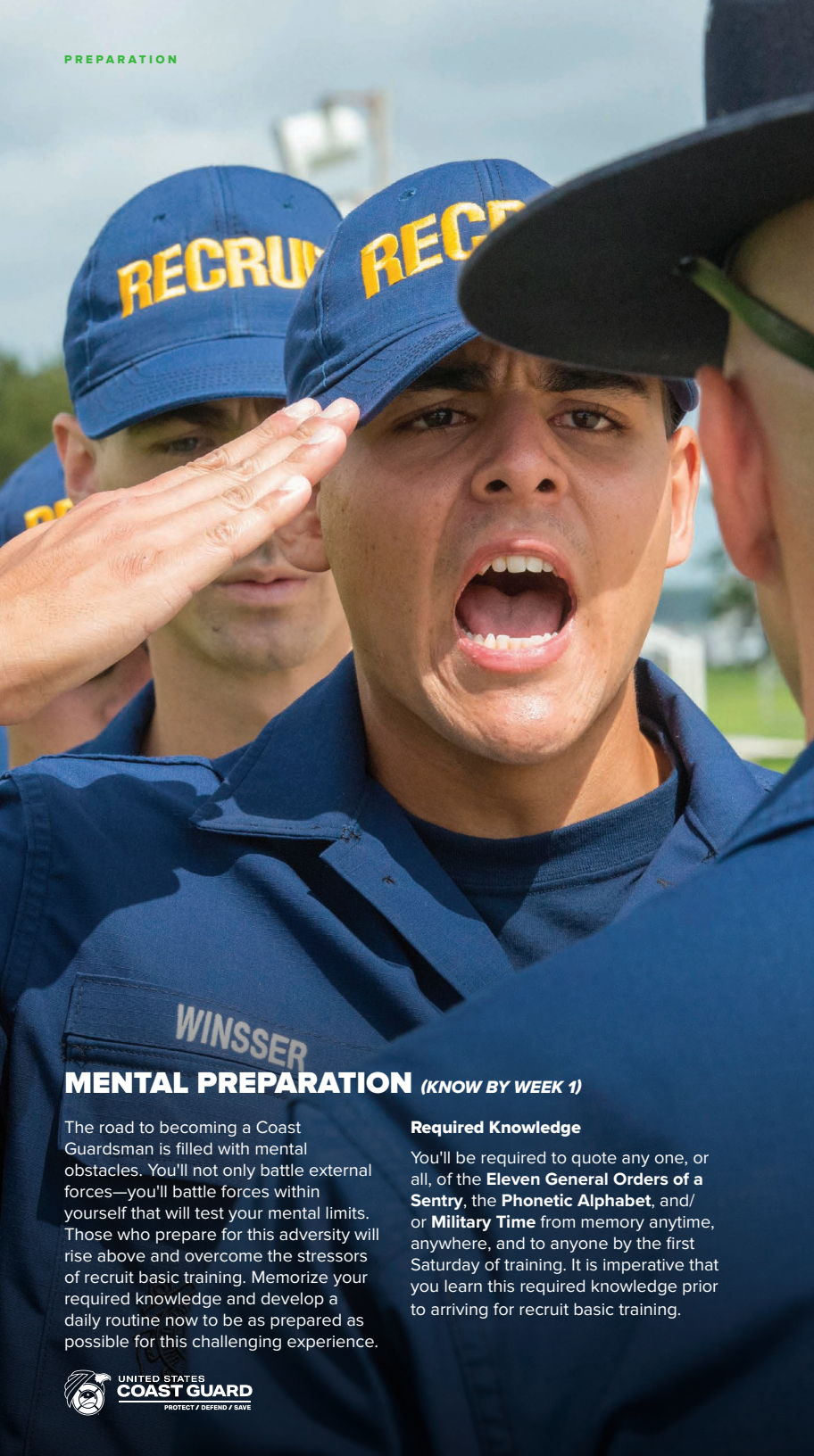


PERSONAL FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT

The best way to achieve financial success is to have a solid, well thought out, and flexible plan. Good financial planning principles include determining where you are now and where you want to go financially. Once you know that, you can ask yourself how you are going to get there and use a budget or spending plan as a map to guide you to your financial destination. Recruit training is eight weeks long, but time may be extended due to medical, academic, disciplinary, or physical setbacks. Therefore, we strongly recommend that you make financial

arrangements with your creditors to either delay payments for three months or pay in advance to cover the time you'll be away at recruit basic training.

When you arrive at basic training, at a minimum you must have a checking account and an ATM card. Your pay will be direct-deposited into this account. The only way you'll be able to access it will be to withdraw it from your personal account with your ATM card, so be sure you try your ATM card at least once before you arrive. ATMs are located at the Coast Guard Exchange.



MENTAL PREPARATION (KNOW BY WEEK 1)

The road to becoming a Coast Guardsman is filled with mental obstacles. You'll not only battle external forces—you'll battle forces within yourself that will test your mental limits. Those who prepare for this adversity will rise above and overcome the stressors of recruit basic training. Memorize your required knowledge and develop a daily routine now to be as prepared as possible for this challenging experience.

Required Knowledge

You'll be required to quote any one, or all, of the **Eleven General Orders of a Sentry**, the **Phonetic Alphabet**, and/or **Military Time** from memory anytime, anywhere, and to anyone by the first Saturday of training. It is imperative that you learn this required knowledge prior to arriving for recruit basic training.



The Eleven General Orders of a Sentry

1. To take charge of this post and all government property in view.
2. To walk my post in a military manner, keeping always on the alert and observing everything that takes place within sight or hearing.
3. To report all violations of orders I am instructed to enforce.
4. To repeat all calls from posts more distant from the Guardhouse than my own.
5. To quit my post only when properly relieved.
6. To receive, obey, and pass on to the sentry who relieves me all orders from the Commanding Officer, Command Duty Officer, Officer of the Deck, and Officers and Petty Officer of the Watch only.
7. To talk to no one except in the line of duty.
8. To give the alarm in case of fire or disorder.
9. To call the Officer of the Deck in any case not covered by instructions.
10. To salute all officers and all colors and standards not cased.
11. To be especially watchful at night, and during the time for challenging, to challenge all persons on or near my post, and to allow no one to pass without proper authority.

Phonetic Alphabet

Letter	Phonetic Letter
A	ALPHA
B	BRAVO
C	CHARLIE
D	DELTA
E	ECHO
F	FOX TROT
G	GOLF
H	HOTEL
I	INDIA
J	JULIET
K	KILO
L	LIMA
M	MIKE
N	NOVEMBER
O	OSCAR
P	PAPA
Q	QUEBEC
R	ROMEO
S	SIERRA
T	TANGO
U	UNIFORM
V	VICTOR
W	WHISKEY
X	X-RAY
Y	YANKEE
Z	ZULU

Military Time

Civilian Time	Military Time
MIDNIGHT	0000
1:00 AM	0100
2:00 AM	0200
3:00 AM	0300
4:00 AM	0400
5:00 AM	0500
6:00 AM	0600
7:00 AM	0700
8:00 AM	0800
9:00 AM	0900
10:00 AM	1000
11:00 AM	1100
12:00 PM	1200
1:00 PM	1300
2:00 PM	1400
3:00 PM	1500
4:00 PM	1600
5:00 PM	1700
6:00 PM	1800
7:00 PM	1900
8:00 PM	2000
9:00 PM	2100
10:00 PM	2200
11:00 PM	2300

Study now. Come ready!

Develop a Daily Routine

The following is an example of a daily routine that you could implement now to prepare for recruit basic training. Remember, only you know what your unique attributes and habits are, what your strengths and weaknesses are, and what influences they have over your current daily lifestyle.

- Wake up every morning at a set time.
- Do a morning workout of push-ups and bent-knee sit-ups.
- Eat breakfast and drink two glasses of water.
- Do an afternoon workout of push-ups and bent-knee sit-ups.
- Eat lunch and drink two glasses of water.
- Fitness training plan.
- Run every other evening.
- Eat dinner and drink two glasses of water.
- Go to bed every night at 2200.

Behavioral Changes & Actions to Consider

- Limit caffeine and energy drinks.
- Quit all tobacco products and e-cigarettes.
- Quit the consumption of alcoholic beverages.
- Limit personal phone usage (phone calls, text, social media, gaming, etc.).
- Limit online usage (gaming, social media, etc.).
- Practice ironing.

*Adjust now.
come ready!*





WHAT TO BRING, WHAT WILL BE ISSUED & WHAT NOT TO BRING

Personal Items

There are three categories of personal items:

- Permitted: items allowed.
- Issued: items issued to you upon arrival.
- Contraband: items strictly forbidden.

Permitted Items for Men & Women

Travel in comfortable, appropriate clothes and sneaker-type shoes. The clothes you wear will be the clothes you sleep in your first night of training.

- ✓ Social Security card (REQUIRED).
- ✓ 1 form of government-issued photo ID (driver's license, state identification, passport, etc.) (REQUIRED).
- ✓ 1 small suitcase or duffel bag with your name printed clearly on it. *IT MUST MEET CARRY-ON MEASUREMENTS.* To calculate, measure the size of your bag by adding the total outside dimensions (length + width + height). The sum should be no greater than 62 inches. The bag will be used to store the clothes you arrive in until after graduation, and any other personal items or electronics you travel with.
- ✓ 2 extra sets of civilian outfits for after graduation (kept in personal bag for the duration of training).
- ✓ \$50 cash in small bills to cover the cost of additional items (company photo, coins, etc.).
- ✓ Sneakers (black, navy blue, gray, or white or a mix of these colors) are recommended, but not required. Bring lightweight, comfortable sneakers designed for running and shaped to fit around the full foot below the ankle with cotton or synthetic laces. All recruits will be issued a pair of athletic sneakers, but having a pair of sneakers that has been broken in for a 3-week period could help reduce injury. Prohibited examples include, but are not limited to: FiveFinger or basketball sneakers, neon or colorful designs, sneakers showing significant wear, and velcro or mechanical laces.
- ✓ 6–10 pairs of underwear (briefs for females and briefs or boxer briefs for males) in white, black, gray, or navy blue.
- ✓ Navy blue long underwear (Oct.–April).
- ✓ Wallet or small purse.
- ✓ Cell phone (kept in personal bag for the duration of training).
- ✓ Wedding band.
- ✓ Non-electric disposable razor and 8-week supply of cartridges.
- ✓ 2 religious reference books.
- ✓ Religious medallion worn on a chain (long enough that it cannot be seen under a v-neck t-shirt).
- ✓ Address book.
- ✓ Stationery, envelopes, and stamps.
- ✓ Shampoo and/or conditioner*.
- ✓ Face wash*.
- ✓ Face, hand, or body lotion* (unscented).
- ✓ Toothpaste* and non-electric toothbrush.
- ✓ Dental floss.
- ✓ Body powder*.
- ✓ Unframed family photos.
- ✓ Water-resistant battery-powered watch (black, brown, navy blue, silver, or gold). Prohibited examples include, but are not limited to: diamond covered, neon, bright colors, white, internet capable, and bands that exceed a 1-inch width. (Watches that require a charge will be kept in personal bag for the duration of training).
- ✓ Invisalign and/or retainer (may only use the appliance you arrive with).
- ✓ Plain black compression shorts with inseam no greater than 4 inches.
- ✓ Prescription glasses.
- ✓ Copy of vaccination records (if available).
- ✓ Brush and/or comb.
- ✓ Optional hair covering for sleeping in flesh/neutral colors.



Permitted Items for Women Only

- ✓ Birth control pills (if already using to maintain cycle).
- ✓ Hairpins (bobby pins), small barrettes, elastic bands, and/or small plain scrunchies (elastic bands covered with material not to exceed 1 inch in width). Only brown, black, navy blue, or hair colors are authorized.
- ✓ 1 set of ball earrings worn in the lowest hole of ear and no larger than a quarter-inch in diameter: gold, silver, pearl, or diamond. Earrings may only be worn for graduation, pictures, and off-base liberty.
- ✓ Makeup* (only worn for graduation, pictures, and off-base liberty).
- ✓ 6 high or medium impact sports bras (white, skin tone, black, gray, or navy blue) and 1 regular bra.
- ✓ Hair gel*.
- ✓ Tampons, pads, underwear liner, menstrual cup, or menstrual underwear.
- ✓ Copy of civilian Pap results (if available).

**Note: As per TSA regulations, you are allowed to bring a quart-sized bag of liquids, aerosols, gels, creams, and pastes in your carry-on bag and through the checkpoint. These are limited to travel-sized containers that are 3.4 oz. (100 mL.) or less per item.*

Note: If you do not bring any of these items, they are available for purchase shortly after arrival, but supplies may be limited.

Issued Items

The following items will be issued to you upon arrival at training:

- 1 rucksack
- 3 bars of soap, 1 soap dish, and 1 antibacterial soap
- 1 deodorant and 1 shampoo
- 1 shower kit
- 1 pair of shower shoes
- 1 washcloth
- 1 lip balm
- 1 dental floss
- 1 toothpaste, 1 toothbrush, and 1 holder
- 1 package of adhesive bandages
- 1 set of nail clippers

- 1 package of razors and shaving cream
- 1 blister kit
- 1 package of cotton balls and swabs
- 2 locks
- 3 laundry pins and 3 laundry bags
- 1 notebook and 1 3-ring binder
- 1 ruler
- 12 pens and 1 highlighter
- 1 stencil kit
- 1 black marker and 1 silver marker
- 1 sewing kit
- 1 shoeshine kit
- 2 ditty bags
- 1 canteen
- 1 penlight
- 2 masking tape rolls
- 2 pairs of compression shorts
- 1 swim shirt
- Insect repellent (May–Sept.)
- Sunscreen (May–Sept.)
- **Women only:** Small mesh laundry bag with laundry pin for delicates.

Not included in the ditty bag, but included in the sea bag: 6 pairs of white socks, 3 pairs of black dress socks, 6 pairs of wool boot socks, 4 towels, 1 pair of running shoes, and all official uniform items.

Contraband Items

The following items are considered contraband and will be disposed of, and possession of some of these items may result in immediate removal from training:

- Alcoholic beverages
- Pornographic photos or materials
- Outside food or beverages
- Magazines and newspapers
- Tobacco, nicotine products, and associated items
- Narcotics or drug paraphernalia
- Weapons

*Prepare now.
Come ready!*

CAPE MAY



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ARRIVAL AT CAPE MAY

Our goal at Cape May is to prepare you for military duty and the stress associated with emergency response operations. Our expert and professional staff will train and test you in **physical fitness, water survival and swim qualifications, wellness and nutrition, self discipline, vocation, academics, military skills, and military bearing.**

We strive to instill a sense of pride and honor in every individual, and to bring you, along with your company, to a new level of excellence.

During the next eight weeks, we'll assist you in making the transition from civilian to military member. You'll gain the understanding of your responsibility to become a committed, productive member of the U.S. Coast Guard, and to define yourself by our core values of **honor, respect, and devotion to duty.**

Honor

Integrity is our standard. We demonstrate uncompromising ethical conduct and moral behavior in all of our personal and organizational actions. We are loyal and accountable to the public trust.

Respect

We value our diverse workforce. We treat each other and those we serve with fairness, dignity, respect, and compassion. We encourage creativity through empowerment. We work as a team.

Devotion to Duty

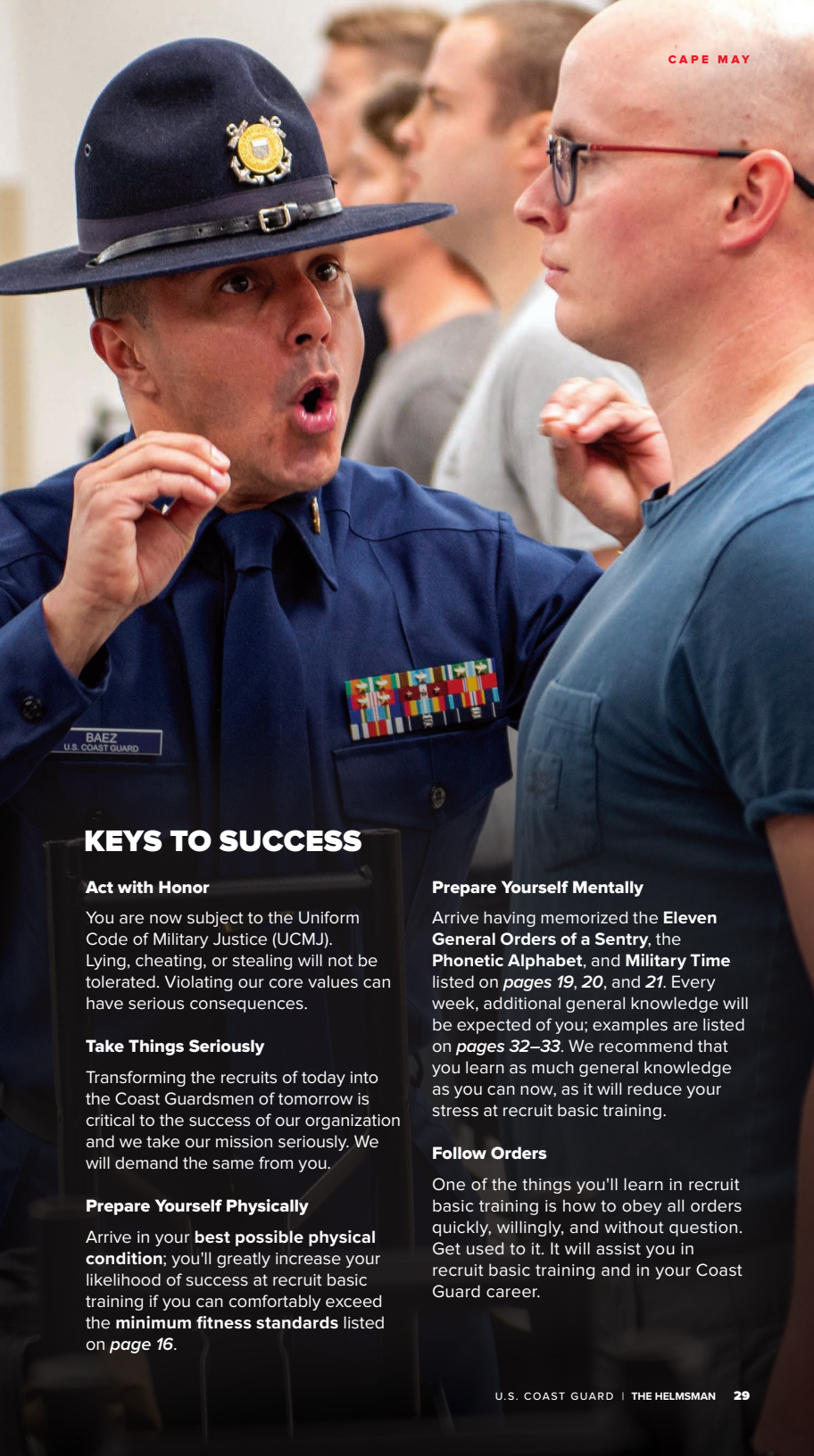
We are professionals, military and civilian, who seek responsibility, accept accountability, and are committed to the successful achievement of our organizational goals. We exist to serve. We serve with pride.

Statement of Rights

Certain rights are fundamental to the welfare of all recruits and shall not be denied. The training environment will be free of discrimination, recrimination, or intimidation based upon a person's race, creed, color, gender, religious beliefs, or sexual orientation. Recruits will not be harassed, and they will not be assaulted. Recruits will be able to attend religious services and see a chaplain upon request, have access to medical care, and address concerns to their chain of command.



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KEYS TO SUCCESS

Act with Honor

You are now subject to the Uniform Code of Military Justice (UCMJ). Lying, cheating, or stealing will not be tolerated. Violating our core values can have serious consequences.

Take Things Seriously

Transforming the recruits of today into the Coast Guardsmen of tomorrow is critical to the success of our organization and we take our mission seriously. We will demand the same from you.

Prepare Yourself Physically

Arrive in your **best possible physical condition**; you'll greatly increase your likelihood of success at recruit basic training if you can comfortably exceed the **minimum fitness standards** listed on *page 16*.

Prepare Yourself Mentally

Arrive having memorized the **Eleven General Orders of a Sentry**, the **Phonetic Alphabet**, and **Military Time** listed on *pages 19, 20, and 21*. Every week, additional general knowledge will be expected of you; examples are listed on *pages 32–33*. We recommend that you learn as much general knowledge as you can now, as it will reduce your stress at recruit basic training.

Follow Orders

One of the things you'll learn in recruit basic training is how to obey all orders quickly, willingly, and without question. Get used to it. It will assist you in recruit basic training and in your Coast Guard career.

CHART YOUR COURSE

You are about to get underway on an **eight-week journey*** that will provide you with the skills and discipline necessary to serve your country. You'll **develop confidence, teamwork skills**, and learn what it means to live in accordance with our core values of **honor, respect, and devotion to duty**.

**Recruit basic training is eight weeks long. However, if you are held back in training for physical fitness, academic, medical, or disciplinary reasons, it could be longer.*

Arrival/Forming Company

Week 1

Start your travel to Cape May well rested. During your first night here, you'll sleep in the clothes you arrive in, so make sure you travel comfortably.

Upon arrival at the Philadelphia International Airport, all recruits must report immediately to the USO office, within the secured side of the airport (not the ticket counter side or the baggage claim side). Follow airport signs or ask a TSA agent for the location of the USO. The Philadelphia USO phone number is 215-365-8889.

If your flight is delayed and scheduled to arrive in Philadelphia after 1930 (7:30 PM), contact Cape May at 609-898-6971, your MEPS travel liaison (information given to you on travel day) and your recruiter.

You should have been allowed to carry your bag onto the plane; however, there may be circumstances in which the airline has you check your bag. Should this occur, upon landing in Philadelphia report immediately to the USO. A USO volunteer will assist you in reclaiming your bag from the baggage carousel. **DO NOT EXIT THE SECURE SIDE OF THE TERMINALS.**

Whether you fly or are driven to the Philadelphia airport, all recruits must comply with TSA security guidelines regarding liquid products and containers. All recruits must pass through TSA security check points (either in Philadelphia or at their

originating airport) to enter the secured side where the USO is located. Any container of liquid in excess of TSA guidelines will be confiscated.

When you arrive at Cape May, the forming process begins. The goal of forming is to get you ready to train. You'll go through administrative processing, medical and dental screenings, urinalysis*, weigh-in, and uniform issue, and males will receive a haircut. On Friday morning, you'll be given your physical fitness assessment**.

**Even though some substances, e.g., marijuana, may be legal under state laws, a positive urinalysis test for controlled or illegal substances under federal law may be grounds for discharge.*

***Failure to meet the physical fitness standards of the bent-knee sit-ups, push-ups, and the 1.5 mile run may result in being held in Week 1 until successful completion of the assessment, being placed in physical fitness remedial training, or being discharged.*

Company Formation

Week 2

On Friday afternoon, you'll be assigned to a recruit training company and meet your Company Commanders. They'll ensure you overcome the challenges of training and make the transition from civilian to Coast Guardsman. Your first weekend with your company will be a challenging time for you. You'll learn how to act as a member of a team, and how to obey orders. Many recruits find this the most difficult period in recruit basic training. Prepare yourself for this. Remember the beginning is hard, but you'll quickly learn how to meet the many requirements and challenges placed upon you. Your first order of business is an introduction to physical fitness and required knowledge. You'll start learning military drill, military customs and courtesies, and begin basic Coast Guard orientation. The more general knowledge you can memorize before you arrive for training, the better off you'll be. On Thursday morning, you'll be given your swim assessment*.

**Failure to meet the swimming standards will result in being placed in Remedial Swim until successful completion of the swimming standards.*



Learning the Basics

Week 3–Week 4

During the third week of training, instruction will consist of military justice, code of conduct, uniforms, ranks and rates, career development, fitness, wellness and quality of life, Coast Guard history, traditions, values, safety, Coast Guard assets and missions, administration and personal finance, watch standing, security, and communications. At the end of the fourth week of training, you'll take the mid-term exam. When you pass this exam, your training will take a significant turn. You'll have the opportunity to submit your preferences for the geographic location of your first assignment. The Coast Guard will then assign you to a unit depending on the needs of the service while attempting to match that need with your location preferences. Rest assured that every non-rate assignment offers the same opportunity for a successful start to your career.

The Coast Guard has a priority to fill certain billets as follows: **Operational Afloat, Operational Ashore, Operations Support**, and finally **General Support**. Therefore, the majority of all recruits find their first duty is operational.

Practical Training

Week 5–Week 6

Your training during this period will be much more practical and hands-on. You'll learn firefighting and marksmanship. You'll learn about line handling and seamanship, and you'll also continue with classroom instruction. At the end of the fifth training week, you'll receive orders to your first assignment and things will start happening quickly. By this phase of training, you'll be conducting yourself as a member of the U.S. Armed Forces. Your training will progress through other practical areas, like close order drill and watch standing. Learning about your military entitlements will also prepare you for upcoming travel arrangements and graduation.

Preparation for Your First Unit

Week 7

You'll be required to contact your new unit and speak with a designated sponsor, who will give you the information you need to make a successful transition to your new duty station. You'll continue with classroom instruction that focuses on leadership, first aid, and CPR. At the end of this week of training, you'll take the final exam.

Graduation

Week 8

Graduation is the culmination of recruit basic training and a proud moment for the graduates, their families, and the Cape May staff. Graduation ceremonies are usually held each Friday morning at 1100. The ceremonies are typically held outdoors in fair weather conditions. In the event of inclement weather and during the winter months, graduations are held in the Cape May gymnasium. Awards that are presented at graduation include, but are not limited to: **Honor Graduate, Leadership, Academic, Most Physically Fit, Best Shipmate, Seamanship, Manual of Arms, Yeoman, and Most Improved Physical Fitness.**



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

Unlike required knowledge, general knowledge is not expected of you upon arrival at Cape May. However, memorization of these general knowledge topics will be required of you later. We provide these select few general knowledge topics if you choose to study them prior to arriving.

Chain of Command

A Chain of Command is a structure of authority and responsibility. It is important that everyone knows their place in the organization, and to whom they have to report. For example, your immediate supervisors are your Company Commanders (CC) and Lead Company Commander (LCC). Their immediate supervisor is the Section Commander (SC), who is the next person in your Chain of Command. This progresses up to our Commander-in-Chief, the President of the United States. Your Chain of Command will be introduced to you during Week 1 of training.

Commander-in-Chief

Secretary of Homeland Security

Coast Guard Commandant

Deputy Commandant for Mission Support

Force Readiness Command

Commanding Officer (CO)

Executive Officer (XO)

Training Officer (TO)

Regimental Officer (RO)

Battalion Officer (BO)

Battalion Commander (BC)

Assistant Battalion Commander (ABC)

Section Commander (SC)

Lead Company Commander (LCC)

Company Commander (CC)

Company Commander (CC)

Company Commander (CC)

Other Helpful People to Know

Command Master Chief (CMC)

Chaplain

Equal Opportunity Advisor

Sexual Assault Response Coordinator



MILITARY DRILL

The following positions are taken only while at a halt. A single person or an entire company may execute them.

Attention

"Attention" is the most basic of all military positions. When you stand at "Attention," you indicate that you are alert and ready to receive instructions. When called to "Attention," you'll bring the heel of your left foot to the heel of your right foot. At "Attention," you'll stand straight with your heels together. Your feet will form a 45-degree angle and your head and body will be erect, hips and shoulders level, and your chest will be lifted. Your arms will hang naturally with your thumbs aligned with the seam of your trousers or skirt. Your fingers will be joined and allowed to curl naturally. Your legs will be straight, but do not lock your knees. Your head and eyes should be directed forward. Your mouth should be closed, and your chin should be tucked in slightly.

Parade Rest

The command "Parade Rest" is only given when the company or person is at "Attention." In a single movement, bring your left foot out to shoulder width and join your hands, right over left, palms facing away from your body, at the small of your back.

At Ease

When given the command "At Ease," the company or person may relax and move about. While "At Ease," your right foot must remain in place. While in this position, you are not allowed to talk.

Fall Out & Fall In

"Fall Out" means you are free to break ranks, but you must remain nearby. When given the command "Fall In," return to your place in ranks and come to "Attention."

Facings

There are three facing movements: "Left Face," "Right Face," and "About Face." While executing a facing movement,

your arms should remain in the "Attention" position.

Right or Left Face

Command: "Right Face." At the command "Face," slightly raise the left heel and right toe. Face the right, turning on the right heel, putting pressure on the ball of the foot and holding the left leg straight. Then, place the left foot smartly beside the right one. "Left Face." Similar to the command for "Right Face," except at the command "Face," you'll turn on the heel of your left foot and pivot with the toe of your right foot.

About Face

Command: "About Face." At the command "Face," place the toe of the right foot about a half-foot to the rear and slightly to the left of the left heel without moving the left foot. Put the weight of the body mainly on the heel of the left foot, right leg straight. Then, pivot to the rear, moving to the right on the left heel and the ball of the right foot. Place the right heel beside the left to complete the movement.

Alignment

Company leaders have the choice of two commands when they want members to align themselves with each other. The first, "Dress Right, Dress" (normal interval) aligns members at arm's length while the second, "At a Close Interval, Dress Right, Dress" cuts the distance between members in half.

Dress Right, Dress

On the command "Dress Right, Dress," all company members, except the right flank member, turn their heads and look and align themselves to the right. At the same time, each division member, except the flank member, lifts their left arm shoulder high (normal interval) or places their left hand on their hip (close interval). The right flank member holds position (stands fast) and looks to the front. The other division members use the right flank member as a guide and take short steps as necessary



fast) and look to the front. The other division members use the right flank member as a guide and take short steps as necessary to align themselves and to achieve the proper interval. Once the alignment is complete, division members hold their position until the “Ready, Front” command is given. At this time, division members snap back to the “Attention” position.



CUSTOMS & COURTESIES

The military in general, and the U.S. Coast Guard specifically, rely on many traditions. Passed on from one generation to the next, these customs, courtesies, and ceremonies help foster discipline and good military order. Customs are usual ways of acting in a given situation. A custom is a long-established practice that carries the force of law. Courtesies are actions or words that express consideration and respect for another person. When people treat others with courtesy and respect, it's more likely they will also be treated with courtesy and respect.

Hand Salute

The salute is one of the required acts of military courtesy. Regulations covering the salute are deeply embedded in military tradition and custom. The salute shows respect and is a sign of comradeship. There are several types of salutes, including the gun salute and rifle salute, but the most common, and possibly the most important, is the hand salute. The hand salute is a simple, dignified gesture that is rendered to the National Anthem, the U.S. Flag, and Officers. Unless you are walking, the hand salute should be rendered while standing at "Attention."

Raise the right hand and bend your arm at the elbow, until the tip of your forefingers touches the lower part of your cover just above and to the right of your right eye. Fingers extend and align with the thumb. With the elbow slightly in front of your body, your upper arm should be parallel with the deck. The hand and wrist must be held in a straight line and the forearm should be at a 45-degree angle. Returning the arm to its normal position at your side completes the salute. This motion is done in one sharp, clean motion.

Salute properly and smartly. A sharp salute is a mark of a sharp recruit. Always use your right hand. Use your left hand to carry objects and leave your right hand free to salute. Accompany your salute with a proper greeting, e.g., "Good morning, Sir/Ma'am," "Good afternoon, Commander Smith," "Good evening, Chaplain Jones." Always salute from the position of "Attention." If you are walking, you need not stop, but hold yourself erect and square. If double timing, slow to a walk when saluting. Look directly into the Officer's eyes as you salute. Salute all Officers who are close enough to be recognized as Officers. Render a verbal greeting if you are carrying something in both hands and cannot render the hand salute. Salute Officers even if they are uncovered or their hands are occupied. Your salute will be acknowledged by the Officer's salute, so continue to hold your salute until the Officer drops his or her salute. It is at that point you shall carry on.



Recruit Communications

When Asked a Yes or No Question

Proper Recruit Response: "Yes" or "No," followed by the person's title and name.

"Yes, Petty Officer Smith."

When Receiving an Order

Proper Recruit Response: "Aye Aye," followed by the person's title and name.

"Aye aye, Petty Officer Smith."

When Asked an Open-ended Question

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by the answer.

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, the Commandant is Admiral _____."

Proper Way to Disregard a Previous Statement

Proper Recruit Response: "Belay my last," Petty Officer Smith, followed by start the statement over.

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, the Commandant is Chief Krug. Belay my last. Petty Officer Smith. Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, the Commandant is Admiral _____."

Providing Unsolicited Information

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by "I request to inform you," followed by the information.

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, I request to inform you the shower is broken and won't turn off."

Requesting Information

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by "I request to know..."

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, I request to know what time graduation practice begins."

Requesting Permission

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by "I request permission to..."

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, I request permission to see the Chaplain."

When Passing by a Staff Member in Close Proximity (When recruits pass within one arm's length of a staff member and no alternate route exists.)

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by "I request permission to pass by."

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, I request permission to pass by."

Repeat a Statement or Directions

Proper Recruit Response: Person's title and name, followed by recruit's title and name, followed by "I request you say again your last."

Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, "I request you say again your last."

A Staff Member Calls a Recruit or Identifies the Recruit, but Doesn't Know the Recruit's Name

Proper Recruit Response: Recruit's last name, followed by "Aye," followed by the name and title of person calling them.

CC states, "Park" or "Recruit"
Recruit states, "Park, Aye, Petty Officer Smith."

Telling Time

"Petty Officer Smith, Seaman Recruit Park, Regimental Sunset is Fourteen Thirty."

1403 = fourteen zero three
0145 = zero one forty-five
0830 = zero eight thirty
1000 = ten hundred
1700 = seventeen hundred
0003 = zero zero zero three

Recruits Do Not Verbally Respond to the Following

Do not respond if the staff member provides the following statements:

"Carry On."
"As You Were."
"Recover."
"Fall In."
"Very Well."
"Fix It."

CAPE MAY



UNITED STATES
COAST GUARD
PROTECT / DEFEND / SAVE



COLORS

Morning Colors

At 0755 hours, the PREP pennant raises to the top of the crossarm when “First Call” sounds. At 0800, the PREP pennant is lowered to half-mast when “Attention” sounds. At the beginning of the music, the national ensign is hoisted quickly and smartly to the peak or truck. Additionally, at the beginning of the music, all recruits face the national ensign and stand at the position of attention. Covered recruits render a salute, and uncovered recruits (in Physical Fitness Gear) cover their hearts.

When the music stops, all recruits return to the position of attention. When “Carry On” sounds, signaling the end of colors, the PREP pennant is lowered all the way down, and recruits carry on with the plan of the day.

Evening Colors

At evening colors (sunset), the procedure is the same as morning colors, except the national ensign is lowered at the start of the music and lowered slowly, so it is hauled all the way down at the end of the music.

RANK STRUCTURE

Enlisted Grade Structure

	SR	Seaman Recruit	E-1
	SA FA	Seaman Apprentice Fireman Apprentice	E-2
	SN FN	Seaman Fireman	E-3

Non-commissioned Officer Grade Structure

	PO3	Petty Officer Third Class	E-4
	PO2	Petty Officer Second Class	E-5
	PO1	Petty Officer First Class	E-6
	CPO	Chief Petty Officer	E-7
	SCPO	Senior Chief Petty Officer	E-8
	MCPO	Master Chief Petty Officer	E-9
	MCPOCG	Master Chief Petty Officer of the Coast Guard	E-9

Warrant Officer Grade Structure



CWO-2

Chief Warrant Officer 2

W-2



CWO-3

Chief Warrant Officer 3

W-3



CWO-4

Chief Warrant Officer 4

W-4

Officer Grade Structure



ENS

Ensign

O-1



LTJG

Lieutenant Junior Grade

O-2



LT

Lieutenant

O-3



LCDR

Lieutenant Commander

O-4



CDR

Commander

O-5



CAPT

Captain

O-6



RDML

Rear Admiral

O-7



RADM

Rear Admiral

O-8



VADM

Vice Admiral

O-9



ADM

Admiral

O-10

ENLISTED RATINGS

	AET	Avionics Electrical Technician
	AMT	Aviation Maintenance Technician
	AST	Aviation Survival Technician
	BM	Boatswain's Mate
	CS	Culinary Specialist
	DC	Damage Controlman
	DV	Diver
	EM	Electrician's Mate
	ET	Electronics Technician
	GM	Gunner's Mate
	HS	Health Services Technician
	IS	Intelligence Specialist
	IT	Information Systems Technician
	IV*	Investigator (Reserve only)*
	ME	Maritime Enforcement Specialist
	MK	Machinery Technician
	MST	Marine Science Technician
	REPLACE W/CYBER Rating?	Musician
	OS	Operations Specialist
	PA	Public Affairs Specialist
	SK	Storekeeper
	YN	Yeoman

NAUTICAL TERMS

ADRIFT: Loose from moorings (applied to anything lost, out of hand, or left lying about)

AFT: Near or toward the stern of the vessel

ALOFT: Above the vessel's uppermost solid structure (overhead or high above)

ALONGSIDE: By the side of the pier or vessel

ALL HANDS/MUSTER/QUARTERS: Assembly of all hands for accountability

AVAST/BELAY: To cancel an order; to cease

AYE AYE: Reply to an order (I understand and will comply)

BARRACKS: Building where military personnel live

BELOW: Beneath the deck (downstairs)

BOW: The front of the ship

BRIGHTWORK: Brass or shiny metal kept polished rather than painted

BROW: A moveable ladder used for boarding a vessel from a pier

BUNK OR RACK: Bed

BULKHEAD: A partition or "wall" on a vessel

CARRY ON: An order to resume work or duties

CAST OFF: To throw off; to let go; to unfurl

COLORS: Raising or lowering of a national flag; ceremonies held at 0800 and sunset

COMPARTMENT: Room

DECK: Floor

EYES IN THE BOAT: Looking straight ahead while at position of attention

FAST: Snugly secured

FORE: Toward the bow of the vessel

GALLEY: The cooking compartment or kitchen on a vessel

GANGWAY: Opening in a bulwark/lifeline that provides access to a brow; an order meaning to clear the way

GEAR LOCKER: Storage room

HEAD: Bathroom

LADDER: Steps

LIBERTY: Permission to leave the base

MAST: The vertical structure from a vessel that holds rigging for flags and pennants, electronic equipment, and the National Ensign while underway; the flagpole at a shore-based unit

MESS DECK: The compartment where enlisted personnel eat

OFFICER OF THE DAY/DECK (OOD): The officer acting directly under the commanding officer who is responsible on an assigned day/watch for overseeing the unit/vessel, preserving order, protecting property, and enforcing regulations

OVERHEAD: Ceiling

PASSAGEWAY: Hallway

PERFORMANCE TRACKER: Recruit progress documentation slip

PORT: Referring to the left side of a vessel when seen by someone facing the bow

QUARTERDECK: Area between squad bays; location where inport vessels and shore units stand watch

REVEILLE: Wake up; start a new day

SCULLERY: Compartment for washing and sterilizing dishes

SCUTTLEBUTT: Drinking fountain; a rumor

SECURE: Lock; put away or stop work

SICKBAY: Hospital or medical clinic

STARBOARD: Referring to the right side of a vessel when seen by someone facing the bow

STERN: The back of the vessel

STRIKE: Lower or bring down

SWAB: Mop

TAPS: Time to sleep; end of day

TOPSIDE: Upstairs

TURN TO: An order to begin work

UNDERWAY: When a vessel is not tied to a pier or at anchor

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Recruit Leadership

The Coast Guard needs good leaders at all levels. Even as a recruit, you'll have the opportunity to step up and take a leadership role. Leadership is the practical application of the Coast Guard's core values—so put what you've learned to work. You'll be challenged, and your hard work will be noticed.

Squad Leaders are appointed by their Company Commanders and have the authority and responsibility in the company to preserve good order, discipline, and security.

Recruit Historians are responsible for documenting the company's progress through recruit basic training on social media for friends and families to read.

Recruit Watch Coordinators coordinate the respective watches the company stands.

Company Yeomen are responsible for performing general clerical duties in the company and assisting Company Commanders with the reports, records, class attendance rosters, medical waivers, and recruit performance trackers.

Recruit Laundry Detail is responsible for executing proper laundry handling procedures.

Recruit Religious Petty Officers attend weekly meetings with the Chaplain, lead company prayers, and work in the chapel.

Recruit Physical Fitness Petty Officers are responsible for leading company stretches and workouts.

Company Mail Orderlies are responsible for the pick-up and delivery of all mail.

The Recruit Band seeks recruits that have the ability to play musical instruments for graduation and off-base events.

The Recruit Choir requires no prior experience. All are welcome to participate.

The Recruit Drill Team requires no prior experience. All are welcome to participate.

Counseling Resources

The training program is very strenuous. This, combined with the challenge of separation from family and friends, sometimes creates a need for recruits to seek counseling. There are several people you can see to discuss your needs. The first person you should talk to is your Company Commander. They have had a lot of experience dealing with issues and problems just like yours. If you feel uncomfortable discussing the problem with them, you can make an appointment to see a Chaplain or another counseling resource. These resources include a staff psychiatrist, equal opportunity advisor, social worker, and staff nurse. Appointments to see these people are made through your Company Commander. The important thing to remember is that you are not alone and someone will always be there for you.

Religious Services

Many people find religious services to be a good way to ease the pressures of training. The training center chapel is staffed by both Catholic and Protestant Chaplains and has services every Sunday morning. Arrangements will be made for you to attend other types of religious services if available in the community, as long as there is no conflict with your regularly scheduled training.

Medical Resources

The training center dispensary provides medical services delivered by physicians, a physical therapy department, a dental clinic, optometry services, and a psychiatrist. They serve recruits and active duty personnel with mild to moderate illnesses, including overnight treatment. Emergency room services are available at local hospitals if needed.



Liberty at Cape May

Liberty is time off from recruit basic training. It can be limited to Training Center grounds only, or your company may earn off-base liberty. Liberty is a privilege that is earned and not automatically given to everyone. If you do not meet all required academic and physical fitness requirements, you'll not normally be afforded liberty. Remember that while on liberty, you represent the Coast Guard and the consumption of alcohol is not permitted.

Relationships with Other Personnel

Recruits are required to report any incident behavior involving inappropriate relations. Failure to report an incident is considered a punishable offense.

Recruits may not socialize with:

- Cape May staff (non-recruit military and civilian personnel).
- Recruits in other companies not in the same week of training.

Inappropriate relationships include:

- Repeated or continued association, discussions (including of a professional nature)*, and sexual or amorous relations between recruits and Cape May staff.
- Non-professional association with recruits from other companies not in the same week of training unless specifically directed by Cape May staff.
- Any sexual or amorous associations or discussions between recruits.

**These discussions may be perceived as an inappropriate relationship because of the frequency of the discussions.*

FAMILY INFORMATION

Coast Guard Family

As a member of the Coast Guard, you become part of our “extended family,” and so do your family members. Many members of the Coast Guard often follow a family tradition, but some are the first Coast Guard members in their family. Whether you are new to the organization or not, it's vital you pass along important information to your family. How you support your immediate family, and how you continue to fulfill your responsibilities to them, are an important part of your military life.

Dependent ID Cards

If you have dependents, you'll fill out the application for a Dependent ID Card once you arrive. The application and letter explaining the procedure will be mailed to your spouse/dependent. They will take the application to the nearest ID card issuing military installation and get a dependent ID card. If they're unable to get to a military installation prior to your graduation, your dependent may get a card issued either at Cape May (following graduation) or at your first duty station.

Telephone Calls

Upon arriving to Cape May, a scripted phone call will be made by the recruit to one individual back home stating they arrived safely to recruit basic training and to pass that information along to others. In addition, a letter will be sent to your family to let them know you arrived safely. During recruit basic training, you may NOT receive personal calls, therefore you may want to contact your family and friends when you arrive at the Philadelphia USQ. Office phones at Cape May are for conducting official business only. Phone use can be granted by your company Commander only in later weeks of training. Recruits are authorized use of their personal cell phones if granted on- or off-base liberty.



WATCH: A period of duty
Emergency Contact Telephone Calls

In the case of an emergency, your family should contact their local American Red Cross office.

Mail

Mail is delivered to Cape May Monday through Friday. Due to the volume of mail received, it may take longer than normal for mail to reach your recruit. Company mail orderlies pick up mail at a time set by the Company Commander and return it to the Company Commander for inspection. Any suspicious-looking letters or packages will be opened by your recruit in the

presence of their Company Commander. Contraband items will be seized. Please see a list on [page 25](#), so you know what may not be sent. Outgoing mail from recruit basic training is picked up twice a day. Recruits should prepare pre-addressed, stamped envelopes at home to maximize letter writing time.

Mailing Address:

SR _____
USCG Training Center
1 Munro Avenue
Cape May, NJ 08204-5083



Work-Life Program

The Coast Guard's work-life program is managed by the Office of Work-Life, a Headquarters program manager staff within the health, safety, and work-life directorate, reporting to the Assistant Commandant for Human Resources. This staff is responsible for establishing, developing, and promulgating work-life policy and interpreting program standards for Coast Guard-wide implementation. The overall objective is to support the wellbeing of active duty, Reserve, and civilian employees and family members.

CG SUPRT:

855-CGSUPRT (855-247-8778)
or visit CGSUPRT.com

Online Resources

Training Center Cape May:

Web: Forcecom.uscg.mil/Our-Organization/FORCECOM-UNITS/TraCen-Cape-May/

Facebook: [@USCoastGuardBootCamp](https://www.facebook.com/USCoastGuardBootCamp)

Coast Guard Recruiting:

Web: GoCoastGuard.com

Facebook/Instagram: [@GoCoastGuard](https://www.facebook.com/GoCoastGuard)

YouTube: [GoCoastGuard](https://www.youtube.com/GoCoastGuard)

U.S. Coast Guard:

Web: uscg.mil

MyCG: mycg.uscg.mil

Facebook: [@USCoastGuard](https://www.facebook.com/USCoastGuard)

Twitter/Instagram: [@USCG](https://www.instagram.com/USCG)



DIRECT ENTRY PETTY OFFICER TRAINING

(DEPOT RECRUITS ONLY)

Mission

The mission of the Direct Entry Petty Officer Training (DEPOT) course is to produce petty officers who, on the basis of their past prior service or who meet the requirements of one of our Reserve petty officer programs, will graduate as highly motivated and basically trained members ready to assume the duties and responsibilities of their pay grade.

Scope

This is an accelerated course with similar standards as the eight-week program. Training will consist of instruction and practical experience in military courtesies, drills and ceremonies, military justice, code of conduct, leadership and supervision, seamanship, uniforms, ranks and rates, career development, first aid and survival, fitness, wellness and quality of life, Coast Guard history, traditions, and values, safety, damage control, small arms, Coast Guard assets and missions, administration and personal finance, watch standing, security, and communications. Cape May will prepare orders to their first unit, issue ID cards, arrange household goods moves, and provide access to a travel agent for flight arrangements. The physical fitness and swim assessments will be conducted early in training. The standards are listed on **page 16**. Training will be held seven days a week, 12–16 hours each day. Members will have limited access to phones, but will be allowed to make calls for family and business requirements periodically. No cellular phones are allowed during training. Advanced travel, DLA, and pay may be authorized to assist members and families with travel.

Know Before You Arrive

Know these items before you arrive to Cape May:

1. All Required Knowledge and General Knowledge
2. U.S. Coast Guard Ethos

What to Expect

In order to meet the mission of the course, your days will be long. The training is well organized, with a professional staff of Company Commanders and instructors whose main goal is to assist you in successfully completing the course. Reveille is at 0530 and Taps is at 2200—a typical day consists of academic classes, hands-on practical training, evening fitness or workbook sessions, and personal “square-away” time. You'll be expected to maintain training standards for your uniform, squad bay, classroom, and behavior. Uniform and squad bay inspections are routinely conducted throughout training. You'll be given an initial physical fitness and a swim assessment during your first week of training and will participate in a fitness program. You'll be formed as a company to promote teamwork, pride, and unit discipline, while marching to and from class. The company will be berthed in a squad bay.

"If you fail to meet graduation standards for any reason, you may be given the option to complete your training with a senior company in the eight-week program. If you decline that option, you'll be discharged from the Coast Guard."



What to Bring

The following items are in addition to what is listed on [pages 24–25](#).

Required Paperwork:

- ☒ Birth certificate

Miscellaneous Items:

- ☒ \$200 spending cash for miscellaneous purchases. You'll make one trip to the Exchange, where you should be prepared to pay for ditty bag items. Additionally, you should be prepared to purchase other authorized necessary items you did not bring.
- ☒ Prior service personnel: Bring ribbons, badges, insignias, and documentation/verification if available.

Physical Fitness

You must arrive to Cape May ready to pass a physical fitness assessment. Due to the short duration of the course, limited remedial physical fitness training is available. If you do not currently work out, you'll need to start. You must arrive ready to pass a swim test. Due to the short duration of the course, limited remedial swim training is available. If you are a poor swimmer, you'll need to get into a swim program prior to arrival.

"If you fail to meet graduation standards, you are given the option to complete your training with a senior company in the eight-week program. If you decline that option, you'll be discharged from the Coast Guard."

Travel Information

When making travel arrangements, plan to arrive at the Philadelphia airport no later than 1600 on the start date of the class. Upon arrival at the Philadelphia International Airport, all DEPOT recruits must report immediately to the USO office located in the secure side (not the ticket counter side) of the airport. Follow airport signs or ask a TSA agent for the location of the USO. **DO NOT EXIT THE SECURE SIDE OF THE TERMINALS.** A USO volunteer will be at the office to assist you with any questions that you have. The USO has a variety of foods available. If your flight is late, if you won't make it to the USO by 1600, or if you have any other problems, contact Cape May at 609-898-6971 and then your recruiter. You'll travel to Cape May from the Philadelphia International Airport via commercial bus. These arrangements will be coordinated between the USO and the Coast Guard. Transportation for late arrivals will be provided at 0800 Monday morning; you'll stay at the USO on Sunday night.





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NOTES



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SEMPER PARATUS

Verse 1

From Aztec Shore to Arctic Zone,
To Europe and Far East,
The Flag is carried by our ships
In times of war and peace;
And never have we struck it yet
In spite of foemen's might,
Who cheered our crews
and cheered again
For showing how to fight.

Chorus

We're always ready for the call,
We place our trust in Thee.
Through surf and storm and howling gale,
High shall our purpose be.
"Semper Paratus" is our guide,
Our fame, our glory too.
To fight to save or fight and die!
Aye! Coast Guard we are for you!

Verse 2

"Surveyor" and "Narcissus,"
The "Eagle" and "Dispatch,"
The "Hudson" and the "Tampa,"
These names are hard to match;
From Barrow's shores to Paraguay,
Great Lakes or ocean's wave,
The Coast Guard fights
through storms and winds,
To punish or to save.

Chorus

Verse 3

Aye! We've been "Always Ready!"
To do, to fight, or die!
Write glory to the shield
we wear in letters to the sky.
To sink the foe or save the maimed,
Our mission and our pride.
We'll carry on 'til Kingdom Come,
Ideals for which we've died.

Chorus



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THE HELMSMAN IS A PERSON WHO PHYSICALLY STEERS THE SHIP IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE ORDERS OF THE OFFICER OF THE DECK. A PROFESSIONAL HELMSMAN MAINTAINS A STEADY COURSE, PROPERLY EXECUTES ALL ORDERS, AND COMMUNICATES USING NAVIGATIONAL TERMS RELATING TO THE SHIP'S HEADING AND STEERING. A HELMSMAN RELIES UPON VISUAL REFERENCES, A MAGNETIC AND GYROCOMPASS, AND A RUDDER ANGLE INDICATOR TO STEER A STEADY COURSE. CLEAR AND EXACT COMMUNICATION BETWEEN THE HELMSMAN AND THE OFFICER OF THE DECK IS ESSENTIAL TO THE SAFE NAVIGATION OF THE SHIP. STEERING A SHIP EFFECTIVELY REQUIRES SKILLS GAINED THROUGH TRAINING AND EXPERIENCE. AN EXPERT HELMSMAN HAS A KEEN SENSE OF HOW A PARTICULAR SHIP WILL RESPOND TO THE HELM OR HOW DIFFERENT SEA CONDITIONS IMPACT STEERING. FOR INSTANCE, EXPERIENCE TEACHES A HELMSMAN THE ABILITY TO CORRECT THE RUDDER IN ADVANCE OF A SHIP SUBSTANTIALLY FALLING OFF COURSE. THIS REQUIRES THE CAPACITY TO ANTICIPATE THE DELAY BETWEEN WHEN THE HELM IS APPLIED AND WHEN THE SHIP RESPONDS TO THE RUDDER. SIMILARLY, A SKILLED HELMSMAN WILL AVOID OVERCOMPENSATING FOR A SHIP'S MOVEMENT CAUSED BY LOCAL CONDITIONS, SUCH AS WIND, SWELLS, CURRENTS, OR ROUGH SEAS. ON-THE-JOB TRAINING AT SEA IS CRITICAL TO A HELMSMAN DEVELOPING ABILITY TO "SENSE" OR ANTICIPATE HOW A SHIP WILL RESPOND IN DIFFERENT CONDITIONS. THE EXPERIENCED HELMSMAN USES MEASURED RESPONSES TO SEA CONDITIONS, EVEN WHEN ENCOUNTERING HEAVY WEATHER THAT MAY CAUSE A SHIP TO PITCH AND ROLL AS IT MAKES ITS WAY THROUGH ONCOMING WAVES. SUBSEQUENTLY, THE HELMSMAN LEARNS TO RELAX AND TAKE INTO ACCOUNT THE VESSEL'S NATURAL RHYTHM IN ORDER TO AVOID OVERSTEERING. CONSEQUENTLY, MORE ACCURATE STEERING IS ATTAINED WITH LESS RUDDER. APPLYING THE MINIMAL RUDDER REQUIRED TO STEER A COURSE REDUCES DRAG OF THE SHIP, THEREBY FAVORABLY IMPACTING THE SHIP'S SPEED AND OPERATING COSTS. ONE OF THE HELMSMAN'S MOST IMPORTANT DUTIES IS STEERING A SHIP IN A HARBOR WHEN REDUCED SPEEDS SLOW A SHIP'S RESPONSE TO THE RUDDER. FOR IT IS DURING SHIP ARRIVALS AND DEPARTURES, WHEN MOST SHIP COLLISIONS OR GROUNDINGS OCCUR. CLEAR COMMUNICATION, THEN, BETWEEN THE OFFICER OF THE DECK AND THE HELMSMAN IS ESSENTIAL FOR SAFE OPERATIONS. THE OFFICER OF THE DECK RELIES UPON THE HELMSMAN TO FLAWLESSLY EXECUTE STEERING COMMANDS TO AVOID A VARIETY OF HAZARDS, INCLUDING MAN-MADE OBSTACLES, LAND FORMATIONS, GROUNDING IN SHALLOW WATERS, AND THE THREAT OF COLLISION WITH OTHER VESSELS. IN ADDITION, POWERFUL SEA TIDES AND RIVER CURRENTS ENCOUNTERED IN PORTS HEIGHTEN NAVIGATION DANGERS, AS A SHIP'S ABILITY TO STOP IS SEVERELY LIMITED.



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